

Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree, currently an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto. Reviews development applications and the transportation studies filed with them, maintains the road and right-of-way data the division relies on, and brings traffic simulation experience from Ontario Line construction staging work and GO rail operations.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards and Official Plan policy, and recommend conditions where something is missing.
- Build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets Transportation Planning depends on, using GIS and Python to merge sources that were scattered across the division.
- Analyze how the limited space in the right-of-way is being used, and what competing demands on it mean for capacity.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and write the memos and briefing notes that settle them.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, combining several years of data into one validated source the division reports from.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what infrastructure constraints and speed restrictions would do to run times and reliability.
- Assessed the service effect of temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction that construction on an operating railway imposes.
- Worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers to settle the variables a service plan had to be built on.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Traffic modelling and simulation: VISSIM, Synchro, MATSim and OpenTrack. Review of transportation and traffic impact studies. Road and right-of-way data, ArcGIS and QGIS. Stakeholder coordination across municipal divisions and agencies. Python (Pandas, NumPy) and SQL. Memos, briefing notes and presentations.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)